

Chapter 97-3

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Xu Qingzhu returned to Dr. Han to pick up the two children and asked a bit more about Xu Tong's situation.

Xu Tong was a premature baby with a weak constitution. He came to the hospital every few days for injections and IV drips. His parents were ordinary working-class people. Although they had medical insurance for reimbursement, 80% of Xu Tong's medications couldn't be reimbursed, so it was like a bottomless pit.

They had already defaulted on their medical bills once before.

Xu Tong was actually quite a well-behaved child—it was just that his mother spoiled him too much. Almost none of the nurses at the hospital dared to give him injections. Even the experienced head nurse was unwilling. Every time anyone gave Xu Tong an injection, they inevitably got berated by Xu Tong's mother until they felt utterly humiliated.

It was fortunate that the doctors and nurses had good tempers. In any other profession, who would put up with her attitude?

Xu Qingzhu also learned from Dr. Han that Xu Tong had somewhat flat feet, so he didn't walk very steadily and often tripped and fell on flat ground. But for a child his age, this was considered normal. A proper diagnosis would have to wait until he was a bit older.

On the way back, Xu Qingzhu was lost in thought.

The two children had originally been worried about Liang Shi, but after Xu Qingzhu's reassurance, they felt at ease. Before long, they fell asleep in the car.

When they got home, Xu Qingzhu couldn't carry them both, so she could only wake them up and have them go upstairs to sleep.

Ling Dang and Sheng Yu rubbed their drowsy eyes and yawned as they followed Xu Qingzhu upstairs.

When they got home, it was Rainbow who opened the door. The little girl frowned and asked how things went.

This was the first time Xu Qingzhu had experienced a scene like this—someone waiting at home for her while she held children's hands. It felt quite warm.

She had Rainbow go open the door to the second bedroom. Sheng Yu said in a voice heavy with sleepiness, "Of course everything's fine. I'm amazing, after all."

Rainbow: "....."

Sheng Yu and Ling Dang closed their eyes again the moment they touched the bed. Xu Qingzhu helped them take off their clothes, leaving them in just their undershirts and underwear.

Children's skin was so soft and tender. Picking them up, they were so small. While helping Sheng Yu undress, Sheng Yu lifted her arms, and when she lowered them, she wrapped them around Xu Qingzhu, nuzzling into the crook of her shoulder, making it a bit ticklish.

After Xu Qingzhu finished, she had Rainbow get into bed to sleep too.

Rainbow slept on the outermost side, Sheng Yu in the middle, and Ling Dang on the other side.

When Xu Qingzhu was about to leave, Rainbow held onto her and asked where Liang Shi had gone, just like a little adult.

Faced with this question, Xu Qingzhu said, "She went to uphold justice."

Rainbow: "?"

"Something came up, and she went to take care of it." Xu Qingzhu coaxed her. "Go to sleep. When you wake up tomorrow morning, you'll see your Sister Liang."

Only then did Rainbow nod obediently and close her eyes.

Looking at Rainbow's well-behaved little face, Xu Qingzhu's heart melted completely.

She couldn't help but lean in and kiss Rainbow's forehead.

Rainbow opened her eyes again. Her eyes were sparkling bright, and her voice was softer than usual. "Sister Xu~"

Xu Qingzhu patted her back. "Sleep now. Good night."

Rainbow pressed her lips together, her eyes blinking. Before closing them, she leaned over to Xu Qingzhu's cheek and gave her a kiss, then said with a smile, "Good night, Sister Xu~"

Xu Qingzhu turned off the light in the room.

The children's world sank into colorful dreams.

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Xu Qingzhu wasn't the type to keep things from Su Yao out of fear of worrying her.

On the contrary, when Su Yao asked, she poured everything out like beans from a bamboo tube. Though she simplified many details, she summarized things concisely. Then she speculated, "She should be released after they finish taking her statement."

Su Yao was stunned for a moment and said in disbelief, "Ah Shi can actually hit people?"

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

"I hit someone too." Xu Qingzhu said. "That person's mouth was too foul."

She had called Ling Dang a "little wretch" and called Sheng Yu a "little mutt."

Then what did that make her?

Directly insulting her entire family—Xu Qingzhu couldn't tolerate that either.

She even somewhat regretted not going over to kick the woman a few times when Liang Shi had her pinned to the ground.

She had missed her chance.

"You can hit people too?" Su Yao asked haltingly, then followed up with, "Did you get hurt?"

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

"No." Xu Qingzhu felt a warmth in her heart. "Liang Shi is quite capable. We're both fine."

Su Yao nodded. "That's good then."

Xu Qingzhu went to the kitchen to heat up two cups of milk, then returned to the master bedroom with Su Yao and handed one cup to her.

Then she leaned against the bed in the master bedroom and checked the time—it was almost midnight.

She had originally wanted to send Sun Meirou a message to let her know, but then she thought that Sun Meirou probably couldn't make any decisions in that household anyway. Better not to add to her troubles.

She would wait until things were investigated clearly before saying anything. They would see each other again when dropping off Ling Dang anyway.

Now that Liang Shi had escalated things with the other party to the police station, this matter had definitely blown up. They might as well take advantage of the chaos to fish in troubled waters¹.

There was definitely something wrong with Xu Tong and his parents. As for what connection Liang Xinran had to all this—that was uncertain.

Why did Liang Xinran suddenly want to take Ling Dang to the supermarket?

After going there, they bumped into Xu Tong, and then Xu Tong just happened to be hospitalized again.

No matter how Xu Qingzhu looked at it, it seemed like a pig-butcherer scam²—specifically designed to extort money.

It was also possible that Liang Xinran just had bad luck. Taking Ling Dang out was well-intentioned, but they happened to run into scammers.

But it was also possible that Liang Xinran was working together with them.

From a subjective standpoint, Xu Qingzhu leaned toward the second possibility. But in terms of likelihood, it should be the first.

Liang Xinran had only been in Haizhou City for about a week. How could she possibly have teamed up with them to run a pig-butcherer scam?

But what could be confirmed was that Xu Tong's family was indeed engaged in extortion.

Footnotes:

¹ **Fish in troubled waters (渾水摸魚):** A Chinese idiom meaning to take advantage of a chaotic situation to gain benefits, similar to the English expression "fishing in troubled waters."

² **Pig-butcherer scam (殺豬盤):** A type of scam originating from Chinese internet slang. The term literally means "pig-butcherer plate/scheme." It originally referred to romance scams where victims are "fattened up" (cultivated with trust) before being "slaughtered" (scammed for money). Here, it's used more broadly to refer to a scheme where someone deliberately creates a situation to extort money from victims.